

SNIPPETS



- Qualcomm forecasts Q1 revenues between \$9.1 billion and \$9.9 billion
- SiTime Corporation acquires Aura Semiconductor's clock products and IP
- Amazon India launches EV lease programme for its last-mile delivery partners
- US and Indonesia to explore possible EV mineral agreement
- Servotek to set up 5000 EV charging stations in India
- AEVA Technologies to manufacture sensors for Nikon's industrial machines
- Tesla to manufacture 25,000-euro car in Germany
- Hyundai Motor breaks ground on US\$1.5 billion EV plant in South Korea

signed between STPINext, a subsidiary of STPI and ecosystem enablers. The LEAP AHEAD initiative targets tech startups in the scaling stage, growth stage, product diversification, or planning expansion into new geographical locations.

Odisha teams up with Synopsys, IESA, ESA to incentivise fabless ecosystem

Odisha, through Odisha4Silicon-2023, has signed MoUs with Synopsys, IESA, and ESA, aiming to boost the semiconductor manufacturing ecosystem. It is the only state incentivising fabless products or IP companies. IESA will assist in capacity-building, organising events, and supporting semiconductor businesses in the state. The Synopsys collaboration will focus on the O-chip programme, addressing fabless ecosystem challenges in semiconductor design and manufacturing. Synopsys has also committed to internships, placement assistance, and readiness assessment for the VLSI domain. The state has also signed another MoU with the Electronics and Computer Software Export Promotion Council (ESC) to promote electronics and IT exports.

Vedanta invites Japanese firms to invest in proposed chip unit in Gujarat

Vedanta Limited, led by Anil Agarwal, is inviting Japanese firms to collaborate and invest in India's electronics manufacturing sector. The focus is setting up India's first electronics manufacturing hub in Gujarat, aligning with the Indian government's initiatives. Vedanta is

in talks to establish a semiconductor chip manufacturing plant in Dholera, Gujarat. Vedanta had previously signed agreements with 30 Japanese technology firms to support the development of India's semiconductor and glass display manufacturing ecosystem.

IBM, MeitY sign three MoUs to advance AI, chip, quantum innovation

IBM has signed three MoUs with entities under the MeitY to collaborate on advancing innovation in AI, semiconductors, and quantum technology. IBM and IndiaAI (Digital India Corporation) will partner to establish the AIIP (AI Innovation Platform) for AI skill and ecosys-



(Courtesy: pib.gov.in)

tem development. IBM will provide access to IBM's watsonx platform for language, code, and geospatial science models. The company will share experience on intellectual property, tools, and skills development for innovation in semiconductor technologies. IBM and the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC) will focus on workforce enablement, industry/

startup development, R&D, and quantum services and infrastructure.

New Delhi CM Kejriwal approves EV aggregator policy

Delhi's Chief Minister, Arvind Kejriwal, has given the green light to a policy for transport aggregators, emphasising increased safety features for riders. This includes a round-the-clock control room to oversee drivers and emergency buttons linked to law enforcement agencies. The directive mandates that all transport aggregators, established or newcomers, shift to electric vehicles by April 1, 2030. The policy also legalises bike taxis in Delhi, setting specific guidelines and licensing criteria. Applicable to operators with a fleet of 25 or more vehicles, the policy enforces penalties for violations. Furthermore, it mandates provisions for cars accessible to those with disabilities and an option for real-time ride tracking.

Ather opens first international EV outlet in Nepal

Ather Energy has opened its first international Experience Centre, 'Ather Space,' in Naxal, Kathmandu, in collaboration with Vaidya Energy, signaling its entry into the Nepalese market. The company plans to establish a total of 10 outlets across seven cities, indicating a strategic expansion in Nepal. Vaidya Energy, part of VOITH, will manage sales and services for Ather and will also lead the setup of Ather Grid charging stations in Nepal.

High-risk medical device makers, importers get 6-month license extension

The Indian government has granted a six-month extension to manufacturers and importers of high-risk medical devices (Class C or Class D), alleviat-